

ABC COMPANY

Code of Conduct

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1. Purpose

This Code of Conduct defines the ethical and professional standards expected of every employee, contractor, and director of ABC Company ("the Company"). It supplements the HR Policy Handbook and applies in all business dealings, whether conducted on Company premises, remotely, or at client or partner locations.

2. Integrity and Honesty

Employees must act honestly in all business dealings, including financial reporting, client communications, and internal record-keeping. Falsification of records, expense claims, timesheets, or performance data is strictly prohibited and constitutes gross misconduct under the Disciplinary Procedure set out in the HR Policy Handbook.

3. Conflicts of Interest

A conflict of interest arises when an employee's personal interests could improperly influence, or appear to influence, their professional judgment. Employees must disclose the following situations to HR via the Conflict of Interest Disclosure Form before they become relevant:

- Financial interest in a supplier, vendor, competitor, or client of the Company.
- Employment of, or business dealings with, a close family member within the Company's supply chain or reporting line.
- Outside employment, consulting, or board positions that could compete with or affect Company duties.
- Acceptance of gifts, hospitality, or favors from clients or vendors beyond nominal value (above USD 75 or local equivalent).

4. Confidentiality and Data Protection

Employees will, in the course of their duties, have access to confidential Company, client, and employee information, including trade secrets, financial data, and personal data. This information must not be disclosed to any unauthorized third party during or after employment, except as required by law. Handling of personal data must comply with the Company's Data Privacy Policy and applicable data protection regulations.

5. Anti-Bribery and Anti-Corruption

ABC Company strictly prohibits bribery and corruption in any form, whether involving public officials or private parties, in any country in which the Company operates. Employees must not offer, promise, give, request, or accept any bribe, kickback, or improper payment intended to influence a business decision. Facilitation payments to expedite routine government action are also prohibited unless required by law and pre-approved by the Legal department.

6. Fair Dealing and Anti-Competitive Conduct

Employees must compete fairly and comply with all applicable competition and antitrust laws. Discussions or agreements with competitors regarding pricing, market allocation, or bid-rigging are strictly forbidden. Employees interacting with competitors at industry events must avoid any exchange of commercially sensitive information.

7. Use of Company Assets and Social Media

Company assets, including equipment, funds, intellectual property, and brand assets, must be used responsibly and solely for legitimate business purposes. When posting on personal social media about the Company, employees must clearly state that views expressed are their own and must not disclose confidential or non-public information, consistent with the IT Acceptable Use Policy.

8. Health, Safety, and Environment

Employees must follow all workplace health and safety guidelines, report hazards or incidents promptly to facilities management, and refrain from reporting to work under the influence of alcohol or unauthorized substances. The Company is committed to minimizing its environmental footprint and expects employees to support waste reduction and energy conservation initiatives at Company facilities.

9. Reporting Violations – Whistleblower Protection

Employees who become aware of an actual or suspected violation of this Code, or of any illegal or unethical conduct, must report it promptly through their Reporting Manager, HR, or the confidential Ethics Hotline (ethics@abccompany.example). Reports may be made anonymously where local law permits. The Company strictly prohibits retaliation against any employee who reports a concern in good faith, and any act of retaliation will itself be treated as a serious disciplinary matter.

10. Acknowledgment and Enforcement

All employees are required to read and electronically acknowledge this Code of Conduct upon joining and annually thereafter via the HR Portal. Violations of this Code will be addressed under the Disciplinary Procedure described in the HR Policy Handbook and, where applicable, may be referred to law enforcement authorities.

This document is a fictional, sample corporate document created for practice, training, or demonstration purposes (e.g., RAG / document-retrieval projects) and does not represent an actual company policy.